

This update (v2026.5.9.2) is a broad polish-and-hardening release. The interface gets a refresh — a redesigned sign-in screen with a daily-changing ambient visualisation, a tidier sidebar, smoother page-to-page navigation, and consistent in-app confirmation dialogs — alongside a long list of reliability and security fixes: faster and more dependable site-to-head-office syncing, stricter permission checks, hardened Sage query validation, and accessibility-grade text contrast throughout. Every figure continues to be drawn from, and reconcile to, Sage.

New Features

NEW

■ Redesigned sign-in screen

The sign-in page has been redesigned with a softer, rounded look and a live ambient visualisation behind the welcome panel.

- Three visualisation styles — drifting phosphor traces, a constellation network, and breathing ledger bars — rotate automatically by day, with gentle colour blooms.
- Respects reduced-motion settings (shows a still image) and pauses when the tab is in the background.
- Rounded input fields with a clear focus glow, a pill-shaped sign-in button, and clearer error messages.

■ Shareable filtered views on Customer Balances

Filters on Customer Balances (age bucket, branch, sales rep, and more) are now part of the page address — copy the link to share exactly the view you're looking at, or bookmark it. Filters also survive a refresh.

- Every filter is encoded: age bucket, branch, sales rep, last-purchase window, dormant-only, account type, hide-invoice-matches and the page number.
- Defaults stay out of the address, so unfiltered views keep a clean link.
- Filter clicks don't clutter browser history — Back still leaves the page in one step.

■ Data-freshness badge on Creditor Balances

A colour-coded badge shows at a glance how current the creditor data is: green when fresh, amber when it has missed its nightly sync, red if it has never synced. Hover for the exact timestamp.

- Green: synced within the expected nightly window. Amber: stale (older than 26 hours). Red: never synced.
- The relative age ('Synced 3h ago') keeps itself up to date while the page is open.
- The tooltip carries the raw sync timestamp plus the schedule, e.g. 'Nightly at 04:30'.

■ Clean-up tool for BAT reconciliation integrity warnings

When the integrity banner reports orphaned extraction rows (stale rows from a prior upload), an admin can now review the exact rows and tick which to remove — nothing is deleted automatically, and rows retained from a second branch's upload are never touched.

- The picker lists each orphaned row with its order number, OCR status, amount and a link to the POD PDF.
- Deletion is admin-only and audited; the server re-checks each ticked row is genuinely orphaned before removing it.
- POD PDFs themselves are never deleted — only the stale database rows.

■ Smoother, steadier navigation

Moving between pages no longer blanks the whole screen while a page loads — the sidebar and header stay put and only the content area shows a brief loading spinner.

- Previously, opening a page for the first time replaced the entire screen — sidebar included — with a blank loading state.
- Pages you have already visited continue to open instantly.

■ Tidier sidebar

Even spacing between groups, a rounded highlight with an amber marker on the current page, and group chevrons that sit next to their labels. Items are indented under a subtle guide line so grouping reads at a glance.

- Collapsed group headers no longer cram together while expanded groups sprawl — the vertical rhythm is even throughout.
- The current page is marked with a rounded highlight and a glowing amber rail instead of a square block.
- Icons are slightly smaller so their colours read as accents rather than dominating each row.

■ Faster, lighter searching

Vendor, stock-receipt and collections searches now send one request per typing pause instead of one per keystroke, and search results no longer flash to empty while new results load.

- Applies to Creditor Search, Creditor Balances, Stock Receipts and the Collections assign-customers dialog (including its minimum-value and days-overdue fields).
- The Operations OCR panel now polls quickly only while OCR is actually running, dropping to a slow check when idle.

■ Large vendor lists render instantly

Creditor Balances now draws only the rows on screen, so the table stays smooth no matter how many vendors are listed. Column sorting also works from the keyboard.

- Only the visible rows are rendered, so scrolling stays smooth at any list size.
- Column widths remain resizable and are remembered per user, exactly as before.
- Sortable headers are reachable with Tab and toggled with Enter or Space, with the sort direction announced to screen readers.

■ Accessibility-grade text contrast

Every de-emphasised label across the app has been lifted to meet the WCAG AA contrast standard — easier on the eyes in both themes, especially on warehouse screens.

- 167 instances of faded text across 60 screens were below the 4.5:1 contrast standard; all now meet it in both themes.
- An accessibility linter now runs in the build pipeline so new screens can't regress.

■ In-app confirmation dialogs

Actions that previously used the browser's built-in confirm popup (deleting a user, bulk collections updates, forcing a full re-sync, changing the VAT rate) now use a themed dialog, with destructive actions clearly marked in red.

- Browser popups ignored the app theme and could be suppressed by the browser after repeated prompts.
- The new dialogs support keyboard confirmation and cancelling with Escape.

■ Aged Creditors — filter by payment history

The Aged Creditors report gains a Payments filter, on by default, matching the Creditor Balances page: 'With payment history' hides never-paid accounts; switch to 'All vendors' to include them. The choice carries through to the PDF and Excel exports.

■ BAT weekly chart — total value per week

The second chart on the BAT Weekly Reconciliation report now shows each week's BAT and Sage credit-note totals. The two lines track closely when a week reconciles; a visible gap is that week's variance.

Fixes

FIXED

■ First-time password setup no longer loops

Setting your password on first sign-in now completes properly instead of asking again on the next sign-in.

- The 'must change password' flag was never cleared after a successful first-time setup, so every subsequent sign-in demanded a new password again.

■ Amounts typed with a comma decimal are read correctly

Typing an amount like 1.234,56 into search-by-amount no longer reads it 100 times too large.

- South African formats (1 234,56 and 1.234,56) and plain formats (1234.56) are all recognised; the last separator typed is treated as the decimal mark.

■ Site-to-head-office syncing is faster and more honest

Sites no longer rewrite every record on each 30-minute sync (the hub now pulls only what changed), updates made during a sync window are no longer missed, and a sync where one dataset fails is reported as partial instead of silently logged as OK.

- Unchanged records are skipped instead of rewritten, so head office stops re-downloading the entire customer book every half hour.
- The incremental window is stamped from when a sync starts (with a safety margin), so an update made mid-sync is picked up by the next one.
- Partial syncs show amber in the Hub Sync Log with the failing dataset named; scheduled imports run one at a time and failures are recorded in Job Runs and can raise alerts.
- Hub Aged Debtors decides per branch whether to use detailed open-item data or the snapshot, so one un-synced branch no longer affects the others.

■ Very large depots sync reliably

Branches with more than ~32,000 stock items no longer fail their inventory sync to head office.

- The previous approach hit a database parameter limit at ~32,000 items, failing the whole sync every cycle so the branch's data went stale.

■ Keyboard shortcut collision

Ctrl+K opened two overlays at once. It now opens only the page-jump command palette; the hidden console moved to Ctrl+Shift+K — and it now answers back whatever you type.

- Ctrl+K: fuzzy page-jump across every page you have permission to open, grouped like the sidebar.
- Ctrl+Shift+K: the quiet-word console — it knows a few words now, and unknown words get a reply instead of silence.

■ Fresh installations start correctly

A brand-new installation could fail on its very first start before the database existed. New installs now boot cleanly.

- Existing sites were never affected — the issue only occurred when the application started against a completely empty database.

■ Aged Debtors dashboard tile respects the branch filter

The Aged Debtors tile on the Reporting Dashboard now correctly reflects the selected branch, showing only that branch's aging totals rather than all-branch figures.

- Selecting a branch from the dashboard's Branch selector now narrows the Aged Debtors tile, consistent with every other tile on the page.

Security

SECURITY

■ Hardened Sage query validation

Custom Sage query overrides are validated with a stricter read-only check that can't be bypassed through comments or quoted text, with a wider list of blocked commands.

- The validator now understands quoted text and comments, so a forbidden command can't be smuggled past it inside a string.
- Blocked keywords now include data-export and server-configuration commands in addition to writes; stored-procedure calls are rejected outright.
- Legitimate queries that use reserved words as column aliases still validate correctly.

■ Tighter permission checks

Several report and rule-management endpoints that previously only required sign-in now enforce the same permissions as the pages that use them.

- Report data endpoints now require the same Reports permission as their export buttons.
- Auto-flag rule testing and editing requires the manage-rules permission.
- The head-office commission bundle download aligns with the Monthly Reports permission.

■ Safer service-to-service authentication

Internal reporting and backup tokens are compared in constant time, and the backup configuration export now defaults to redacting secrets unless explicitly configured otherwise.

- Constant-time comparison prevents an attacker from recovering a token byte-by-byte from response timing.
- Exporting the full unredacted configuration now requires an explicit opt-in setting, instead of depending on an environment flag being set.